

Rehan Minhas
66C Chandos Crescent
Edgware
HA8 6HL

10 November 2025

Dear Rehan

I am writing to provide you with my decision regarding your grievance dated 6 October 2025 following our grievance meeting on 3 November 2025.

In making my decision I have considered your input at our meeting, all information provided by you and the investigation interview notes which were shared with you prior to our meeting.

I commend the clarity of each element of your grievance which certainly assisted a focussed investigation and me in assessing each element of your grievance. I also commend your openness and direct responses at our meeting. I would also commend the candour of each witness interviewed and their evidence produced a clear and consist picture of the circumstances which surrounded the elements of your grievance.

At our meeting, we covered the five points documented in your grievance letter dated 6 October 2025, along with two further points taken from the documentation supplied by you for the pre investigation meeting preparation dated 6 October 2025, 8 October 2025 and 13October 2025. I have also reviewed the overall procedure that has been followed as you submitted a number of complaints about the process being followed after your grievance was submitted. I have listed all these matters below and then addressed them individually in this decision letter.

1. Insecure storage and suspected unauthorised sharing of my special category health data.
2. Repeated public humiliation and intrusive questioning.
3. Discriminatory probationary targets post-disclosure.
4. Failure to refer to Occupational Health (OH) despite five UKSL 425 health reports.
5. Pressure to work in safety-critical clean-room environments despite known medication side effects (incontinence).
6. Request for probation feedback from colleagues.
7. Exacerbation of mental and physical medical situations.
8. Procedure

Insecure storage and suspected unauthorised sharing of my special category health data

You reported in the grievance letter that your disclosure to your manager, of your medical details, was recorded by your manager in an excel file. You believed this to be an insecure location. You also believed that the medical information was passed onto other people, the suspicion triggered by being asked how you were.

Your concerns focussed during the investigation meeting on the fact that your medical information had been written down and that you believed the data security breach to be the actual recording on your information.

Output

Recording factual or relevant medical information is a necessary management action provided confidentiality is retained.

Your manager denies adding any details to an excel spreadsheet. He confirmed he does record notes on his secure One Drive. Subsequent to our meeting, I asked HR to confirm if your manager had any medical information related to you recorded on his One Drive or on an excel spreadsheet. HR have confirmed he does not have any health information related to you on his One Drive or on any excel spreadsheet.

In addition to the point above there was no association between individuals asking how you were and specific medical information.

I would add that references to you lacking confidence or looking nervous appear reasonable, bearing in mind you were in probation and on at least one occasion you were not able to undertake a process you had been signed off following your training. I also note your manager tried to reassure you not to be nervous.

There is no evidence to suggest that the manager breached confidentiality or improperly disseminated information about you.

Therefore, this element of the grievance is not upheld.

Repeated public humiliation and intrusive questioning

You reported in the grievance letter that enquiries about your well-being were felt to be intrusive to you, specifically as you wanted to keep your medical matters private.

You explained that at times you did have to leave the manufacturing floor due to the medical issues or the side effects of medication you were taking.

In the investigation meeting you confirmed that initially you felt it a welcome inclusive team experience to be asked how you were but that changed when you felt the number of times

was excessive. You self-managed the situation that was making you feel uncomfortable by asking your line manager to remove / reduce the enquiries from the team. This was noted in the interview notes.

We explored if you reflected on why team members might be asking if you were OK, as you did need to leave your tasks on the manufacturing floor and that this alone could have been the trigger for their concern. You confirmed that you had not reflected on this or did not believe the events to be connected.

Output

It is acknowledged that you reported experiencing discomfort due to repeated enquiries about your well-being on occasions when you was experiencing medical issues, however during the investigation meeting there was no evidence of malicious intent or inappropriate conduct by team members.

It appeared to me that the behaviour of colleagues was a normal reflection to your absences.

I also note that when the matter was raised with your manager he was careful to refrain from asking how he was.

Therefore, this element of the grievance is not upheld.

Discriminatory probationary targets post-disclosure

You reported in the grievance letter that you were assigned discriminatory probation targets. When asked to describe the targets set you provided the example of 90% CSOD target in the Induction booklet vs 95% CSOD target completion in the revised probationary targets. No other probationary target outside the expected role tasks was detailed during the meeting or in your documentation.

Your concerns focussed during the investigation meeting on the fact that your probation targets were different from other people's targets. You explained that you sought input from other people to help you determine how to achieve the set targets.

You confided that there was a lot of pressure and a lot of scrutiny to complete the targets and responded when asked if the target or the pressure was the issue, that the grievance was mostly about the pressure to deliver the targets rather than the target itself.

Output

There was no evidence from any manager or witness to suggest that your probation targets were different to any other probationer or outside the expectations of the role, the existing CSOD assignments or site-specific targets.

Your manager's evidence regarding the extension of your probation period was clear and clearly justifiable based on the evidence of your knowledge of key element of your role and your confidence in undertaking certain tasks.

Therefore, this element of the grievance is not upheld.

Failure to refer to Occupational Health (OH) despite five UKSL 425 health reports

During the meeting you reported that you experienced two different medical events and these were handled differently. You explained that one incident (eye infection) resulted in an Occupational Health meeting and the other incidents (diarrhoea), with 5 separate event reports being submitted for 5 events, did not result in a meeting.

You also raised concerns having submitted forms (UKSL-425) and (UKSL-1783).

You reported that a manager / lead did ask verbally, on a separate occasion, if you wished to be referred to Occupational Health for one of the diarrhoea events but you felt the moment had passed and you were well enough to carry on working.

Your own description of this condition was that it resulted from medication you were taking and was therefore not a contagious illness which might preclude you from working on the plant floor.

You also reported that you had been referred to Occupational Health following a return to work interview, had met with Occupational Health but had not received a report of the meeting at the time of the investigation meeting.

Your concerns focussed during the investigation meeting on the fact that experienced different processes for medical matters that kept you away from your place of work on the manufacturing floor.

Post meeting

After our meeting I asked HR for additional information on the occupational health referrals with a rationale that the differences in referrals discussed in the investigation meeting needed to be understood.

I have summarised HR's response below.

"I can confirm that I found out the following information as a result of speaking to OH, Rehan's new hire form triggered an initial referral to OH, they made contact and an appointment was arranged for 27Aug, It was decided that he would require a face to face meeting with a Physician rather than a telephone consultation. An appointment was set but due to an apparent confusion regarding the date Rehan did not attend. They then contacted Rehan again to rearrange for 24 Sep however the

Physician caught Covid and had to cancel the meeting as he was unwell and couldn't attend f2f. A consultation was completed on 08 Oct, during which it was determined that a further, more formal assessment was required, so no report has been provided to date.

In the meantime, a further 2 referrals have been made. 1. By Razwan Jamil (manager) based regarding mental health and 2. By myself for an eye infection. The referral I made has been followed up and concluded, as the referral Razwan made is related to the original referral there has not yet been a response yet.

The employee's next meeting with OH is on 13 Nov.

For background, we have a nurse on site weekly but a Physician is only present once per month.

Output

It was clarified for you in the meeting that procedure (UKSL-425) and form (UKSL-1783) were intended for recording incidents that might impact Product and were not for individuals wishing to have a personal occupational health referral.

It was clarified post the meeting that the eye infection event was a very specific request for an OH appointment which occurred and was closed out.

You were offered occupational health support for specific medical events which you declined as not being needed at the specific time of offer.

OH meetings activated by the *New Starter Declaration* and combined with your manager request regarding mental health are currently ongoing and support is being made available.

Therefore, this element of the grievance is not upheld.

Pressure to work in safety-critical clean-room environments despite known medication side effects (incontinence)

You raised concerns that you were made to feel pressured to return to work in a clean room, whilst experiencing a repeating medical event (diarrhoea).

During the meeting you confirmed that although you were not forced to return to the clean room, you felt uncomfortable with repeated requests if you indeed felt well enough to return to the clean room. You also reported that you had expected medical advice to be sought on your behalf.

You confirmed that you were aware working in a clean room environment was known to be part of your role.

Output

It is acknowledged that you reported experiencing discomfort due to requests for timeframes for returning to duties, however during the investigation meeting there was no evidence of malicious intent or inappropriate conduct by team members.

There were clear examples of colleagues not being able to complete tasks due to your absence and seeking cover during your absences.

Since clean room work is part of normal duties, as understood from the role description discussion, managers were entitled to seek clarity on your ability to work on the plant floor. It would appear that on certain occasions managers were direct in terms of their questioning but when this was raised by you, management were asked to be more considerate of your circumstances.

There was no evidence to suggest that company procedures were not followed or that any manager or team leader intended to act insensitively.

Therefore, this element of the grievance is not upheld.

Two additional concerns, which were raised in the body of the evidence package, were covered during the meeting

Feedback Request

You raised a concern that feedback you requested was not provided and was potentially blocked from being given to you. You explained that you had sought feedback, from people that had conducted your training, in order to improve your performance and develop in your role.

During the meeting you confirmed that you had not checked whether it was normal practice to request probationary feedback from colleagues but had used approaches from previous roles you held external to Lonza. HR interviews with individuals requested to provide your feedback indicated that it was not a usual request that they received.

Through the training levels there are mechanisms for discussing progress and with this route being normal practice, it may have yielded the feedback you were seeking.

There was no evidence to suggest that company procedures were not followed or that you were treated unfairly in comparison to other employees.

Exacerbated Symptoms

You documented in your grievance letter that your mental and physical symptoms were exacerbated by your encounters whilst at work. You also noted that your mental health is a long-term condition.

During the meeting you confirmed that you were stable at the time you started at Lonza and the conditions specifically exacerbated since starting at Lonza were loss of appetite and loss of sleep, both of which made you more anxious and distressed.

The remaining mental and physical symptoms provided in your grievance letter were not stated to have been exacerbated by working at Lonza.

I must restate that at our meeting I found you both accommodating and open and I hope that by reviewing the extensive witness evidence obtained as part of this process that you are able to see that there has been no concerted actions against you and that in fact your colleagues and managers have acted reasonably and when issues have been raised to them they have tried to support you.

Procedure

Subsequent to submitting your grievance, you raised various complaints regarding the procedure being followed, the timing of responses and the independence of the investigator.

I was glad to note that in our meeting that you did not repeat any of these concerns.

Having reached my conclusions and reviewed all of the evidence, I confirm I would not have upheld any complaints against HR regarding their handling of your grievance.

It is not always possible to reply to emails or messages immediately but I would commend the HR team that they responded to all your messages promptly and professionally and the investigator as you see from the interviews notes, acted entirely independently in simply asking questions and recorded the responses.

Although, my decisions may not be what you wanted I hope you accept they are a balanced assessment of the situation and evidence.

I have asked HR to get in touch with you to see if there is any assistance they can provide to help you at work or with any work relationships.

Finally in accordance with Lonza's Grievance Procedure if you want to appeal against any of my findings set out in this letter (Stage 2 of the Grievance Procedure) you should submit, within 5 working days of this letter, detailed written grounds of your appeal

to Laura Jones in HR (laura.jones@lonza.com) and she will make the necessary arrangement for an appeal meeting.

Your sincerely

Suzanne Kennedy-May

Suzanne Kennedy-May
Director, Asset Transition Lead